

CORDEL WILLIAMS

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EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology

Atlanta, GA

M.S., Computer Science — Machine Learning Specialization 2022

B.S., Computer Engineering 2015

EXPERIENCE

Cisco Systems, Inc. Alpharetta, GA

Software Engineer in Test — Cisco Secure Firewall

Nov 2025 – Present

- Design and own automated test infrastructure for Cisco Secure Firewall, validating security policy enforcement, failover behavior, and threat detection across distributed deployments.
- Drive shift-left quality initiatives by embedding test architecture directly into the CI/CD pipeline, reducing regression escape rate and accelerating release confidence.
- Apply adversarial testing methodologies to security-critical code paths, probing edge cases in authentication, authorization, and network policy enforcement.

Senior Software Engineer | Scrum Master

Nov 2024 – Nov 2025

- Promoted for consistently delivering high-quality, scalable code; led technical initiatives that improved system performance and drove measurable gains in customer satisfaction.
- Mentor junior engineers through structured code reviews and knowledge-sharing sessions, improving team velocity and code quality standards.

Software Engineer II | Scrum Master

Apr 2021 – Nov 2024

- Spearheaded security assessments for Cisco Secure Network Analytics (SNA), identifying and mitigating vulnerabilities in proprietary and open-source dependencies across the product surface.
- Led end-to-end design and delivery of a deprecated-feature removal initiative in SNA, coordinating across multiple teams to ensure zero customer-impacting regressions.
- Served as Scrum Master for an Agile team of 6+ engineers; streamlined sprint workflows and communication channels, resulting in on-time delivery across multiple release cycles.
- Resolved critical customer escalations in real time for global enterprise clients, reducing mean time to resolution (MTTR) and preserving customer SLA commitments.

Software Engineer I

Nov 2016 – Apr 2021

- Designed and implemented a Failover System for SNA, improving system redundancy and uptime by 40%; system handles millions of network flow records per second on Vertica.
- Developed TACACS+ remote authorization for Stealthwatch, securing \$10M+ in government contract revenue by maintaining required federal security certifications.
- Built a centralized network management system, streamlining device configuration, topology discovery, and flow data ingestion at scale.
- Optimized high-throughput flow data pipelines in Vertica, sustaining processing of millions of network flows per second under peak load.

Macy's Systems and Technology

Atlanta, GA

Java Developer

Jan 2016 – Nov 2016

- Engineered TALOS, an in-house logistics platform, improving warehouse efficiency and order fulfillment throughput across multiple distribution centers.
- Developed Spring Boot microservices for critical business workflows, improving system scalability, fault isolation, and maintainability of core retail operations.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Java (8+), Python 3, SQL
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS (Solutions Architect — in progress), Docker, CI/CD (Jenkins/GitHub Actions)
- **Frameworks & Tools:** Spring Boot, Hibernate, REST APIs, Vertica, gRPC
- **Testing & Quality:** Automated test frameworks, contract testing, adversarial/security testing, regression pipelines
- **Observability:** Network telemetry, flow data analytics, system performance monitoring
- **Certifications:** Advanced Certified ScrumMaster (A-CSM); AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner; AWS Solutions Architect Associate (in progress)